

Looking for work outside

Unit 2

Applying for work



Unit 2: Looking for work outside: applying for work: teachers' notes

Unit 2: Looking for work outside: applying for work: resources

Unit 2: Looking for work outside: applying for work: answers

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Overview

This resource is intended to help learners preparing for release to develop the language they need to apply for jobs and write a CV. It focuses on how to set out a CV and present themselves positively in writing.

Level : ESOL Entry 1-3; National 2- 4, CEFR A1-B1

Time: 90 minutes

Aims

- to read a simple CV and answer questions about it
- to develop learners' ability to write a simple CV
- to develop learners' ability to talk about themselves

Objectives

All learners will be able to:

- read a CV and match the headings
- read a CV and answer questions about it
- start to plan a CV with appropriate layout
- to describe yourself in a positive way

Entry 2 / National 3 learners will be able to:

- use a variety of adjectives and structures to talk about yourself

Entry 3 / National 4 learners will also be able to:

- write questions for lower-level learners to answer about a CV

Preparation

You will need:

- **Resource 1** – one copy per learner
- **Resource 2** – to display or one copy per pair (print in colour if possible)
- **Resource 3** (optional) – print a few copies to illustrate what a CV is
- **Resource 4** – give one copy per learner
- **Resource 5a** – each page has two copies so you will need to cut the sheet in half before giving to each learner (give to Entry 2/National 3 and below)
- **Resource 5b** – give one copy per Entry 3/National 4 learner
- **Resource 6** – print one copy and cut the words out along the line (as an extension task for higher-level learners)



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- Some sticky notes for Activity 5 (one pack should be enough)

Consider

You may wish to do some background reading on issues for ex-offenders seeking employment and use extracts to enable learners to read them and understand how to best account for time spent in prison and to make them aware of disclosure requirements. You could also give them to higher level learners to read for themselves.

<http://hub.unlock.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/ROA-Easy-Read.pdf>

<http://site.stgilestrust.org.uk/what-we-do/p490-skills-and-employment-support.html><http://disclose.me.uk/resources/useful-links/>

As mentioned in Unit 1, it would be worth providing learners with information from other organisations which support ex-offenders such as See the following websites for ideas and support for your learners:

Working Chance <http://www.workingchance.org/> – an organisation which helps women with convictions to find work

The Prince's Trust www.princes-trust.org.uk helps young people to realise their potential;

Unlock <http://www.unlock.org.uk/> helps ex-offenders who want to get into work.

Warmer (10 minutes)

- Write 'apply for' on the board and ask learners what you can apply for. Possible answers: a job, a passport, a council house; in prison, learners may be familiar with filling in apps or applications.
- Put learners in pairs and ask them to discuss how to apply for a job in the UK. Check learners know what it means to apply (apply for a job - to show that you want a job).
- Elicit class feedback.

Differentiation

- If learners have studied Unit 1 of the teacher's pack, invite them to describe the job application process (see Resource 4 of Unit 1). Also find out who works in prison and how they applied for their role in prison. Is the process similar or different to inside?
- Pair learners so that those who are new to prison can work with those who have been inside for longer.
- Some learners may be able to describe how they apply for work in their home country. What do they do differently?

Note: In some countries, job application procedures may be different from the UK. Submitting formal applications and CVs may not be as common.



Activity 1: Talking about yourself (20 minutes)

- Tell learners that to apply for a job they need to be good at speaking positively about themselves or 'selling themselves'.
- They need to be able to talk about their skills, personality, education and interests. Write these words on the board. Hand out **resource 1**. Ask learners to match the words with the examples given.
- Elicit what the words mean by asking a range of learners to give an example of a skill, work experience, education and interests.
- Put learners in pairs and hand out a copy of **resource 2** per pair. Ask learners to describe the pictures and use the speech bubbles to help; for example, 'I can drive', 'I was a cleaner', 'I went to school', 'I like football.' Elicit some of the learners skills and experiences.
- Ask learners to copy this table with enough space to interview each other or photocopy it for them.

name	skills & personality	work experience	education	interests

- Invite learners to make questions to elicit the information about someone. For example:

What's your name?

What skills do you have?

Tell me about your personality.

Do you have any work experience?

Tell me about your education.

What are your interests?

- Drill the questions and statements (with the whole class, sections and individuals) to support all of the learners and give them confidence.
- Set the task for learners to interview two or more of their classmates.

Differentiation

- Low-level learners: once the others are working on the activity, sit with the learners and go over the questions again. Assist them to interview at least one learner and give their own answers only.

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- Ask higher-level learners to provide more examples to show they understand the words in **resource 1**.
- Ask early finishers to note three things they can do or have experience of that would appeal to a potential employer offering a job they would like.

Activity 2: Reading a CV – matching the headings (10 minutes)

- Group learners according to level and display **resource 3** and try to elicit if anyone knows what a CV is. If they do not know, ask them what the document is for. For example, ask *'Do you give it to a friend or to someone who can give you a job?'* Make sure they understand that it is used record your work experience and other details to use to apply for a job.
- Give a copy of **resource 4** to all learners.
- Invite learners to scan the document to tell you what it is. For example, ask *'Is it a letter, an email or a CV?'*
- Give them time to read the information and match the headings into the CV. The headings are: *profile, work experience, education, skills, interests*. If learners do not remember these words, refer them back to **resource 1** which used some of the words. *Profile* is a new term so you will need to explain this: ask them to read the profile and elicit what information it has = a short description of what someone is like and what work they want.
- Elicit information about Dusan's work experience. Ask, *'Is he working?'* *'Is he studying?'* Ask learners, *'Should you write that you are/ you were in prison on your CV?'*

Differentiation

- Ask E2 / N3 learners and above to describe what a CV is. They could work with a partner to write a definition and compare it with another pair. Finally agree on a class definition that everyone understands.
- Support lowest level learners with the reading and encourage them to use **resource 1** to help them remember the meaning of the vocabulary.

Activity 3: Describing yourself - adjectives (10 minutes)

- Invite learners to look at the profile section of the CV. Ask them to describe Dusan.
- Elicit what words he uses to describe himself: hardworking and flexible.
- Tell learners they are going to learn more words to talk about themselves.
- Hand out **resource 5a** and **5b** for learners to work through. **Resource 5a** is lower level and; **Resource 5b** is more demanding.

Differentiation:

- If any lower-level learners completes Resource 5a quickly, ask if they want to try a more difficult version give them Resource 5b for him to try.

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- For early finishers ask them to write their own sentences at their level and peer-check with a partner.

Activity 4: Reading a CV – answering questions (15 minutes)

- Tell learners to draw another copy of the table in Activity 1.
- Ask learners to work in pairs to read the CV to find information about Dusan..
- Cut or fold copies of Dusan's CV in half horizontally and give each one a different half to read.
- They then take it in turns to ask each other questions about Dusan.
What are his skills? what is his education? What languages does he speak? And so on.
- Lower- level learners could just ask 'What..?' questions. Encourage higher levels to vary their question words e.g. 'How many languages can he speak?'
- .Ask them to write his information into the table.

Differentiation

- E3 / N4 learners can write questions about the CV and then give the questions to lower-level learners to answer.
- Lower-level learners can ask the questions they rehearsed in Activity 1 but in the 3rd person for higher-level learners to say and write the answer on the form.
- Higher-level fast finishers can try to memorise the adjectives from Resource 5b. You could show them how to practise learning new words. For example, look at the words for one minute, then turn over the page and write as many words as they can.
- Give any beginners a highlighter pens and work with them (or ask a class supporter if you have one) to find the answers and highlight them before copying the answers onto the form which you have drawn for them.

Activity 5: Planning your CV (15 – 30 minutes)

- Ask how many learners have a CV. Tell learners they are now going to plan their CV.
- Give each learner about five or six sticky notes. Tell them to write on each note something important that they want to include in their CV. Refer them to the example CV to help them and the table in Activity 1.
- Before learners are ready to fill in the blank CV, they will need support to think about the dates of when they studied or did different jobs. It may help to write a timeline of their life and note the jobs or education they have had.

Differentiation

- Lower-level learners may not be ready to write their own CV. Work with them to write what they can. Commend them for anything they are able to do. Ensure they have completed all of the tasks in Activity 1 to 4.
- Higher-level learners should swap theirs with a partner to peer check and feedback.

Cooler (10 minutes)

- Repeat speaking task in Activity 1 as a review to monitor the language learners have practised during the lesson. Encourage learners to give more details and to use the vocabulary in the lesson.

Follow up / extension activities

Help learners to access a computer so they can produce a professional looking CV. If you are able to obtain a room with computers, find some time for learners to type up their CV. If not, encourage learners to write it out in their best handwriting.

Bring in other model CV templates downloaded from reputable job-seeking sites for learners to practise and choose a format that suits them best.

Resource 1

Match the words with the examples

name

skills

personality

work experience

education

interests

friendly

football, TV

mechanic for five years

college 2000 - 2002

can use computers

Mohammed



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Resource 2 – Picture prompts

Look at the pictures. What can you see? Talk about your life.



I can drive.

I like...

I was...



Resource 3 – a CV



Resource 4

Dusan Linska CV

I am looking for part-time work. I am hardworking and flexible. I have experience as a gardener, cleaner and packer.

Personal details

Email: dusan1980@mail.co.uk

Phone: 07811 012152

Date of birth: 20 April 1985

2014 – 2015: Entry 1 ESOL Speaking & Listening certificate

1996 – 2000: Secondary school education in Czech Republic

2012 – 2014: Gardening contractor, self-employed

2010 – 2012: Cleaner, cleaning office buildings

2008 – 2010: Packer, packing in a crisp factory

2000 – 2008: Packer, packing in a biscuit factory

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- Languages: Czech (fluent); English (elementary)
 - Computers: Microsoft Office (Word, Excel and PowerPoint)
 - UK driving licence

I like sport and weight lifting. I go to the gym every day. I like learning new things.

References available on request



Resource 5a Describing yourself (Entry 1)

Task 1: Match the words with the sentences

strong	hardworking	honest	a team player	friendly
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1. A person who works hard is _____.
2. A person who is nice to people is _____.
3. A person who does not lie is _____.
4. A person who works well with people is _____.
5. A person who can lift heavy things is _____.

Task 2: Choose three words to describe yourself

I am _____, _____ and _____.

Task 3: Think of any more words to describe yourself.

_____	_____
_____	_____

Resource 5b Describing yourself (Entry 2 and 3)

Task 1: Match the words with the definitions

creative	flexible	hardworking	honest
organised	punctual	reliable	a
team player			

1. A person who works hard is _____.
2. A person who has good ideas is **creative**.
3. A person who you can trust is _____.
4. A person who is always on time is _____.
5. A person who is ready to change is _____.
6. A person who tells the truth is _____.
7. A person who works well with other people is _____.
8. A person who is tidy and good at planning is _____.

Task 2: Choose three words to describe yourself

I am _____, _____ and _____.

Task 3: Think of any more words to describe yourself.

Resource 6 (extension for Entry 3 learners)

creative	flexible	hardworking
honest	organised	punctual
reliable	a team player	<i>add your own adjective here</i>
works hard	has good ideas	you can trust
always on time	ready to change	tells the truth
works well with other people	is tidy and good at planning	<i>add your own definition here</i>

Resource 7 Your CV

_____ CV

Profile (What are you like as a worker? What work do you want?)

Personal details

Email:

Phone:

Date of birth:

Work experience (What jobs have you done? Say from when to when)

From To (dates)

Education (what certificates or qualifications do you have?)

Skills (What languages do you speak? Can you drive? What else?)

Interests (What do you like doing outside work?)

References available on request



Answers

Resource 1

name	Mohammed
skills	can use computers
personality	friendly
work experience	mechanic for five years
education	college 2000 - 2002
interests	football, TV

Resource 4

The headings on the CV are:

Profile
Personal details
Education
Work experience
Skills
Interests

Resource 5a

Task 1

1. hardworking
2. friendly
3. honest
4. a team player
5. strong

Resource 5b

Task 1

1. hard-working
2. creative
3. reliable
4. punctual
5. flexible
6. honest
7. a team player
8. organised

